

CLAT Express - May 2026: Practice Quizzes

MCQ: +1 for a correct answer, -0.25 for a wrong answer. TITA (type-in-the-answer): +1, no negative marking.

Multiple-choice passages

UAE Visit Outcomes Check

Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visit to the United Arab Emirates focused on energy security, defence, technology and investment. Energy was a central theme, with an Indian strategic reserves company signing a memorandum of understanding with Abu Dhabi National Oil Company for strategic collaboration. Talks also covered storing crude oil at Fujairah under India's Overseas Strategic Reserve Framework. Separately, Indian Oil Corporation and ADNOC signed a strategic collaboration agreement on LPG supply security, and a long-term LPG sale agreement was under consideration.

On defence and maritime matters, the framework for a Strategic Defence Partnership was advanced. A memorandum between Cochin Shipyard and Drydocks World aims to establish a ship repair cluster at Vadinar. Cooperation also includes offshore fabrication under the Maritime Development Fund Scheme.

In technology, a term sheet was signed for setting up supercomputing clusters, linked to India's AI Mission and a partnership between C-DAC and G42. Investment was also on the agenda, as two institutions agreed to explore investments in India's infrastructure sector.

Taken together, these outcomes show how India's partnership with the UAE now extends well beyond trade into petroleum security, shipbuilding, artificial intelligence and infrastructure finance. Several arrangements were signed, while others remain at the stage of proposals or discussions.

Q1.

Who is the Prime Minister of the UAE according to the booklet?

- (A) Sheikh Khalifa bin Zayed Al Nahyan
- (B) Mohammed bin Zayed Al Nahyan
- (C) Abdullah bin Zayed Al Nahyan
- (D) Mohammed bin Rashid Al Maktoum

Q2.

Which facility is described in the booklet as the world's largest airport terminal?

- (A) Abu Dhabi International Airport
- (B) Jebel Ali Port
- (C) Barakah Nuclear Power Plant
- (D) Al Maktoum International Airport

Q3.

How many of the following statements about the UAE are correct?

- I. The UAE signed a Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement with India in 2022.
 - II. Indian nationals form the largest expatriate community within the UAE.
 - III. Al Maktoum International Airport is located in Abu Dhabi.
- (A) Only one
 - (B) Only two
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) None

Q4.

How many barrels of ADNOC crude oil did India propose to store in its Strategic Petroleum Reserves?

- (A) 10 million barrels
- (B) 20 million barrels
- (C) 50 million barrels
- (D) 30 million barrels

Q5.

Assertion (A): The UAE is the only nation participating in India's Strategic Reserve Programme.

Reason (R): The UAE accounted for 18% of India's remittance flows.

Select the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the UAE:

- I. The UAE is India's 3rd largest supplier of LNG.
- II. The UAE is India's 2nd largest crude oil source.
- III. The UAE is India's 2nd largest export destination, after the US.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and III only

Q7.

Which of the following is the naval component named in the booklet's list of UAE defence cooperation?

- (A) Al Dhafra Air Base
- (B) Desert Cyclone
- (C) Desert Eagle
- (D) Zayed Talwar

Q8.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Trade between India and UAE in FY 2025-26	A. Up to US\$ 1 billion
II. UAE share of India's remittance flows	B. 30 million barrels
III. Investment explored by ADIA and NIIF	C. 18%
IV. Proposed ADNOC crude storage in India	D. US\$ 100 billion

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (C) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B

OPEC and the UAE Exit: MCQ Set

Oil-producing countries have long coordinated their output so that crude prices do not swing too sharply. When prices fall too low, exporters that depend on petroleum revenue lose income, and when supply runs ahead of demand, the market can become oversupplied. Recently the United

Arab Emirates announced that it would leave the producer group and its wider alliance with other oil exporters, a move seen as a major geopolitical shift. Collective decisions by the group have traditionally helped it shape global oil prices, so the departure of a large producer may reduce that influence. Member countries have different national priorities and economic needs, which can make agreement on output levels difficult even within a well-established group. Such limits are usually set by agreement among members. Output quotas were one reason behind the exit, because they limited how fully the UAE could use its expanding capacity. The booklet also points to growing competition among producers, including rivalry between the UAE and a major regional neighbour. The episode matters for importing countries such as India as well, since lower prices could ease their import bills while greater volatility could make long-term budgeting harder. Taken together, the exit shows how energy markets, regional politics and national economic goals are closely linked.

Q1.

Where is the headquarters of OPEC located?

- (A) Vienna, Austria
- (B) Brussels, Belgium
- (C) Geneva, Switzerland
- (D) Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

Q2.

OPEC was established at which conference?

- (A) Bandung Conference
- (B) Vienna Conference
- (C) Geneva Conference
- (D) Baghdad Conference

Q3.

Consider the following statements about OPEC:

- I. Ecuador was suspended from OPEC in 1992.
- II. All OPEC member countries are signatories to the UNFCCC.
- III. Ecuador rejoined OPEC in 1992.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the above

Q4.

Which of the following was NOT a founding member of OPEC?

- (A) UAE
- (B) Iraq
- (C) Iran
- (D) Venezuela

Q5.

Assertion (A): The UAE's exit reduces OPEC's collective ability to control global oil prices.

Reason (R): The UAE is a major oil producer.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. The UAE aims to reach about 5 million barrels per day by 2027.
- II. The UAE holds the world's 6th largest oil reserves.
- III. Russia was the world's largest oil producer in 2022.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q7.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Peak Oil Theory	A. Connects Habshan to Fujairah
II. OPEC Fund for International Development	B. Proposed by M. King Hubbert
III. OPEC+ alliance	C. Established in 1976
IV. Habshan-Fujairah Pipeline	D. Formed in 2016

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (C) I-A, II-D, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A

Q8.

Which country terminated its OPEC membership in January 1995?

- (A) Gabon
- (B) Libya
- (C) Nigeria
- (D) Ecuador

Panel recommendations check

Exam malpractice damages more than one test. When the credibility of the system falls, the market value of degrees and merit rankings can fall with it. Re-conducting a compromised examination also places a heavy financial burden on government institutions, and large-scale cheating makes parents and students lose confidence in educational fairness. Students are hit too. Cancellations delay admissions, and honest candidates face stress and demotivation.

After the NEET-UG 2024 controversy, the Ministry of Education set up a high-level committee. Its major recommendations address the functioning of the testing agency and the way examinations are conducted. The panel proposed limiting the role of the National Testing Agency to entrance examinations, and it suggested a technology-enabled authentication system. It also called for governance reforms through an empowered governing body, and for more secure examination centres. Over time, the panel suggested that future entrance examinations move gradually towards computer adaptive testing.

Q1.

How many new posts did the panel recommend creating for administration, IT infrastructure and digital security?

- (A) Five
- (B) Fifty
- (C) Twenty
- (D) Ten

Q2.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Governance reforms	A. Computer Adaptive Testing
II. Institutional restructuring	B. Technology-enabled authentication system
III. Digi-Exam framework	C. Empowered governing body with sub-committees
IV. Shift towards online examinations	D. Creation of 10 new posts

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D
- (C) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D

Q3.

Consider the following statements about the panel's recommendations:

- I. The panel recommended an empowered governing body with dedicated sub-committees.
- II. The panel recommended that private coaching institutes be used as examination centres.
- III. The panel proposed gradual adoption of Computer Adaptive Testing for future entrance examinations.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q4.

How many of the following statements about the panel's recommendations are correct?

- I. The NTA should focus only on entrance examinations for higher education institutions.
- II. The panel proposed creating 10 new posts for administration, IT infrastructure and digital security.
- III. The panel recommended an empowered governing body with dedicated sub-committees.
- IV. The panel recommended that the NTA conduct recruitment examinations.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q5.

How many sub-committees did the panel recommend for the empowered governing body?

- (A) Five
- (B) Two
- (C) Four
- (D) Three

Q6.

For which institutions did the panel propose limiting the NTA's role to entrance examinations?

- (A) Higher education institutions
- (B) Schools
- (C) State governments
- (D) Private coaching centres

Q7.

The panel's proposed technology-enabled authentication system is similar to which existing system?

- (A) DigiLocker
- (B) UPI
- (C) Aadhaar
- (D) Digi-Yatra

Court ruling: legal reasoning

The Madhya Pradesh High Court has ruled on the Bhojshala - Kamal Maula Complex, a medieval monument in Dhar, Madhya Pradesh. Relying on findings from a survey by the Archaeological Survey of India, the court declared the complex a Hindu temple dedicated to Goddess Vagdevi, another name for Saraswati. In the same ruling, the court quashed an earlier ASI order that had allowed shared worship at the site. The bench held that the Places of Worship Act, 1991 could not be applied here, because the site is a protected monument under the Ancient Monuments and Archaeological Sites and Remains Act, 1958. The freeze on religious character in the Act does not extend to such monuments. The Muslim side had relied on a proclamation issued by the princely State of Dhar in 1935. The bench rejected this reliance, noting that the Government of India Act, 1935, on which the proclamation rested, had not been enforced until a later date. The case was treated as a writ petition seeking enforcement of the fundamental right to worship, unlike the Babri Masjid dispute, which was a title suit about ownership. To balance the rights of both communities, the court directed the State Government to consider applications for allotting alternative land within Dhar for a mosque or prayer site.

Q1.

Which section of the Places of Worship Act, 1991 excludes ancient monuments under the AMASR Act, 1958 from the religious character freeze provision?

- (A) Section 3
- (B) Section 4(1)
- (C) Section 4(3)
- (D) Section 6

Q2.

The Government of India Act, 1935, on which the Dhar proclamation rested, was not enforced until when?

- (A) August 1935
- (B) August 1947
- (C) April 1937
- (D) January 1950

Q3.

Under which article was the Bhojshala case treated as a writ petition seeking enforcement of the fundamental right to worship?

- (A) Article 14
- (B) Article 25
- (C) Article 32
- (D) Article 226

Q4.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Section 3	A. Religious identity same as on 15 August 1947
II. Section 4(1)	B. Exempts ancient monuments under the AMASR Act, 1958
III. Section 5	C. Maximum 3 years imprisonment and fines
IV. Section 6	D. Prohibits conversion of a place of worship

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C
- (B) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D
- (C) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (D) I-A, II-C, III-B, IV-D

Q5.

Consider the following statements:

- A. The 2003 ASI order allowing shared worship was quashed.
- B. The Babri Masjid dispute was treated as a writ petition.
- C. The bench accepted the 1935 proclamation of Dhar as valid.
- D. The findings relied upon came from a 2024 survey by the ASI.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q6.

Under which government was the Places of Worship Act, 1991 passed?

- (A) Janata Dal-led National Front government
- (B) Atal Bihari Vajpayee-led NDA government
- (C) Manmohan Singh-led UPA government
- (D) P V Narasimha Rao-led Congress government

Expansion of the Supreme Court Bench

The Supreme Court of India sits at the apex of the country's judicial system and is described as the final interpreter and guardian of the Constitution. It began functioning in the early months of 1950 and took over the role of the highest court of appeal that the British Privy Council had earlier held. The Court's strength is not fixed in the Constitution; it can be changed by law, and it has grown over the years from its original size. The Union Cabinet has now approved a bill to enlarge the bench further. The government's aim is to tackle the Court's growing caseload, which has led to a massive backlog of cases. A bigger bench is expected to speed up the disposal of cases and improve timely delivery of justice in constitutional and civil matters. It would also make it easier to constitute constitution benches, special benches and larger benches for important cases. Such an expansion is seen as a way of strengthening judicial capacity. The amendment bill must pass through both Houses of Parliament before it can take effect, and it also needs the President's assent. Judges of the Court are appointed by the President, and the Constitution sets out the organisation, independence, jurisdiction and powers of the Court in detail.

Q1.

The Union Cabinet approved a bill to expand the Supreme Court to how many judges, counting the Chief Justice of India?

- (A) 36
- (B) 42
- (C) 40
- (D) 38

Q2.

Assertion (A): Parliament can increase the number of judges of the Supreme Court by law.

Reason (R): Article 124 of the Constitution empowers Parliament to increase the number of Supreme Court judges by law.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Justice Soumitra Sen (2011)	A. Resigned before impeachment proceedings could be initiated
II. Justice Ramaswami (1993)	B. Motion failed due to lack of signatures
III. Justice C. V. Nagarjuna (2017)	C. Motion failed as Lok Sabha abstained from voting
IV. PD Dinakaran (2011)	D. Impeached in Rajya Sabha but resigned before Lok Sabha discussion

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-B, III-A, IV-D
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-B, IV-D
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B

Q4.

Consider the following statements about the Supreme Court of India:

- I. The Chief Justice of India is appointed by the President after consulting such judges as he deems necessary.
- II. A Supreme Court judge holds office until attaining the age of 65 years.
- III. A Supreme Court judge is removed by the President on the recommendation of the Union Cabinet.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

How many of the following statements about the Supreme Court of India are correct?

- I. It was inaugurated on 26 January 1950.
- II. It originally had eight judges, including the Chief Justice.
- III. It succeeded the Federal Court of India.
- IV. Its advisory opinion is binding on the President.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Q6.

Under Article 127, before the CJI appoints a High Court judge as an ad hoc judge of the Supreme Court, whose previous consent is required in addition to consultation with that High Court's Chief Justice?

- (A) Attorney General of India
- (B) Union Minister of Law and Justice
- (C) President of India
- (D) Prime Minister

Q7.

Articles 124 to 147, which deal with the organisation, independence, jurisdiction and powers of the Supreme Court, are placed in which Part of the Constitution?

- (A) Part 3
- (B) Part 4
- (C) Part 5
- (D) Part 6

Q8.

Which judge was NOT superseded when AN Ray was appointed Chief Justice of India in 1973?

- (A) JM Shelat
- (B) KS Hegde
- (C) AN Grover
- (D) HR Khanna

Mergers, Exceptions and Member Categories

The anti-defection framework exists to discourage legislators from switching sides. The rules sit in a schedule of the Constitution and cover members of both Parliament and State legislatures. Their aim is to keep governments stable and to make legislators accountable for their conduct. Not every departure is treated the same way, however. The law treats independent members and nominated members differently, depending on when they choose to join a party. Political parties enforce discipline through whips, which direct members how to vote, and the law links defiance of those whips to possible loss of membership. The framework also allows whole groups of members to combine with another party under certain conditions, a feature critics say can encourage large-scale movement between parties. Decisions on these cases are taken by the presiding officer of each house, and courts review those decisions in limited ways. Judges have stressed that such decisions should not be delayed indefinitely, while commentators continue to question whether presiding officers can act impartially when they belong to the ruling party. The debate reflects a wider tension between stable government and the independence that individual legislators may want to exercise.

Q1.

The Anti-Defection Law is enshrined in which Schedule of the Indian Constitution?

- (A) 8th Schedule
- (B) 9th Schedule
- (C) 10th Schedule
- (D) 11th Schedule

Q2.

Assertion (A): Independent members can be disqualified for joining a party after their election.

Reason (R): Independent members can join a party at any time without penalty.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. 52nd Constitutional Amendment Act (1985)	A. Removed the split provision
II. 91st Constitutional Amendment Act (2003)	B. Decisions ideally within 3 months
III. Keisham Meghachandra Singh vs Speaker Manipur (2020)	C. Phrase linked to party-switching in the 1960s
IV. Aaya Ram Gaya Ram	D. Introduced the Anti-Defection Law

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (B) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (C) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (D) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B

Q4.

Consider the following statements about the Anti-Defection Law:

- I. The Chairman of Rajya Sabha decides disqualification petitions of Rajya Sabha members.
- II. Members are not disqualified if two-thirds of a legislature party agree to merge with another party.
- III. The 91st Constitutional Amendment Act (2003) allowed one-third of members to split without disqualification.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I and II only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

How many of the following statements about the Anti-Defection Law are correct?

- I. Nominated members are disqualified if they join a party after six months of nomination.
 - II. Decisions on disqualification should ideally be made within six months.
 - III. A legislator who is declared of unsound mind by a court can be disqualified.
- (A) Only two
 - (B) Only one
 - (C) Only three
 - (D) None

Q6.

Under which Articles of the Constitution can a legislator be disqualified on general grounds?

- (A) Articles 100(1) and 189(1)
- (B) Articles 105(1) and 194(1)
- (C) Articles 110(1) and 199(1)
- (D) Articles 102(1) and 191(1)

Q7.

How does the Anti-Defection Law curtail legislative freedom?

- (A) It restricts members from voting independently and expressing dissent in the legislature
- (B) It bans members from speaking in Parliament without party approval
- (C) It prevents members from joining parliamentary committees
- (D) It bars members from raising private member bills

Q8.

Under the Anti-Defection Law, which exception applies when a legislator votes against the party whip?

- (A) If the Supreme Court grants a stay
- (B) If prior permission is taken or the party condones the action within 15 days
- (C) If at least half the party members support the action
- (D) If the Speaker approves the deviation beforehand

Reserves Under Pressure

India's foreign exchange reserves have come under visible pressure in recent months, and this has raised concern about the country's external position. The reserves are external assets held by the Reserve Bank of India, and they act as a buffer when the economy faces outside shocks. They also help the country pay for essential goods such as crude oil and fertilisers. When inflows of foreign currency exceed outflows, the balance of payments strengthens the reserves and supports the rupee. When outflows rise, the reserves can shrink and the currency can weaken. Several forces added to the outflows in 2026. Crude oil prices have been volatile, which raises the energy import bill. Demand for gold imports has also reached record levels. The central bank has been active in the market, intervening to defend a rupee that was weakening. The Prime Minister has urged citizens to limit non-essential spending on gold purchases, overseas travel and fuel. The aim is to protect currency stability and reduce capital outflows. Experts caution, however, that overly strict controls could stifle manufacturing and broader economic growth. They argue that the country must protect its financial security without damaging its industrial base, and balancing these two goals is the central challenge for policymakers in the months ahead.

Q1.

Which rank does India hold among the world's gold consumers, according to the booklet?

- (A) 2nd largest
- (B) Largest
- (C) 3rd largest
- (D) 4th largest

Q2.

What share of its crude oil requirement does India import, according to the booklet?

- (A) About 58%
- (B) About 69%
- (C) About 75%
- (D) About 89%

Q3.

Which of the following is NOT a component of India's Foreign Exchange Reserves?

- (A) Foreign currency assets
- (B) Domestic government securities
- (C) Gold reserves
- (D) Special Drawing Rights

Q4.

Which statement describes the 'Protectionism Trap' in the context of excessive forex conservation?

- (A) Excessive tariffs lead to WTO disputes and trade sanctions
- (B) Foreign companies exit the Indian market, reducing competition
- (C) Import restrictions increase input costs, reducing export competitiveness
- (D) Domestic companies become dependent on government subsidies

Q5.

Assertion (A): Household gold imports widen India's current account deficit.

Reason (R): Household gold imports add to productive capacity in the same way as sovereign reserves do.

Select the correct option.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q6.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Gold consumer rank	A. Gold accounts for about 9% of total imports
II. Crude oil import share	B. Rise of USD 1.5 to 2 billion in the import bill
III. Gold share of total imports	C. 2nd largest gold consumer globally
IV. Effect of a USD 1 rise in oil price	D. About 89% of crude oil requirement imported

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-D, II-B, III-A, IV-C

Q7.

Consider the following statements about the effects of excessive forex conservation:

- I. Restricted imports of capital goods, semiconductors and raw materials can lower industrial output.
- II. Private consumption is a minor component of GDP, so suppressing it has little effect on growth.
- III. Capital control concerns can raise the country risk premium and dampen FDI and portfolio inflows.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q8.

How many of the following statements about India's forex reserves and imports are correct?

- I. Forex reserves declined by nearly USD 38 billion within two months before May 2026.
- II. Imported urea and ammonia prices have roughly doubled.
- III. Foreign investors are attracted to economies that lack strong domestic demand.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None

Rankings and Key Findings 2026

Reporters Without Borders (RSF) has released the World Press Freedom Index 2026, the 24th edition of its annual report. The Index measures the level of freedom available to journalists in each country and region, and this year it covers 180 countries. Rankings are shaped by legal protections, the diversity of media outlets and the extent of political interference. Each country receives a score on a fixed scale, and the results show sharp contrasts. Some states remain at the top of the table, while others sit at the bottom with severe restrictions on reporters. Between these extremes, many countries have moved up or down because of changes in government or pressure on news organisations. Regions also differ greatly, and journalists in some parts of the world face far greater danger than others. The national questionnaire behind the Index asks experts about the political, legal, economic, social and security environment in each country. Its findings suggest that a free press is closely linked to informed public debate in any society.

Q1.

For how many consecutive years had Norway been top-ranked in the 2026 Index?

- (A) Five
- (B) Seven
- (C) Ten
- (D) Twelve

Q2.

What score did Norway receive in the World Press Freedom Index 2026?

- (A) 88.92
- (B) 92.72
- (C) 82.27
- (D) 97.20

Q3.

What percentage of countries face 'Difficult' or 'Very Serious' conditions for journalism?

- (A) 32.5 per cent
- (B) 42.8 per cent
- (C) 52.2 per cent
- (D) 61.4 per cent

Q4.

Assertion (A): Global press freedom has declined in 2026.

Reason (R): A majority of countries face 'Difficult' or 'Very Serious' conditions for journalism.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Syria	A. Rank 157th with score 31.96
II. Niger	B. Sharpest rise after political transition
III. India	C. Second-highest score at 88.92
IV. Netherlands	D. Steepest ranking fall due to military rule

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-C, II-B, III-D, IV-A
- (B) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A

Q6.

Consider the following statements about the World Press Freedom Index 2026:

- I. Norway was top-ranked for the 10th consecutive year.
- II. Only 1 per cent of the world's population lives in countries rated 'Good' for journalism.
- III. Syria's ranking fell sharply after its political transition.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) II and III only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) I, II and III
- (D) I and II only

Q7.

How many of the following statements about the World Press Freedom Index 2026 are correct?

- I. The index covers 150 countries and regions.
- II. Norway topped the index for 10 consecutive years.
- III. India ranked 151st in 2026.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the above

Q8.

Which country was ranked second in the World Press Freedom Index 2026?

- (A) Estonia
- (B) Netherlands
- (C) Denmark
- (D) Sweden

LEADS basics check

Logistics performance across India's States and Union Territories is measured through LEADS, a national index that benchmarks each State and UT on common parameters. The report is prepared by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade, which works under the Ministry of Commerce and Industry. The seventh edition, released as the LEADS 2025 Report, evaluated States and UTs on parameters such as infrastructure, service quality, regulatory environment and data-driven logistics reforms. The report is presented across several logistics-related categories. The 2025 edition also changed how results are classified. In place of the earlier three-tier model, it introduced a four-tier system, and States and UTs are now sorted into new groups. Excellence and innovation in the sector are recognised through a separate set of awards called LEAPS, which were conferred alongside the report. The LEADS framework takes inspiration from an international

benchmark, the Logistics Performance Index of the World Bank. That global index analyses differences between countries in customs procedures, logistics costs and infrastructure quality. The national and global tools therefore differ in scope, since one compares States and UTs within India while the other compares countries.

Q1.

Consider the following statements about LEADS 2025:

- I. The LEADS Report is prepared by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade.
- II. LEADS was launched in 2015.
- III. The 2025 edition uses a four-tier classification system.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) I and III only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q2.

How many of the following statements about LEADS are correct?

- 1. LEADS stands for Logistics Ease Across Different States.
- 2. LEADS was launched in 2020.
- 3. LEADS draws inspiration from the World Bank's Logistics Performance Index.
- 4. LEADS is prepared by the Ministry of Railways.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q3.

In which year was LEADS launched?

- (A) 2015
- (B) 2016
- (C) 2018
- (D) 2020

Q4.

Across how many logistics-related categories is the LEADS 2025 Report presented?

- (A) 9
- (B) 11
- (C) 17
- (D) 13

Q5.

Assertion (A): The LEADS framework draws inspiration from the World Bank's Logistics Performance Index.

Reason (R): The World Bank's Logistics Performance Index is reported every two years.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q6.

What does LEAPS stand for?

- (A) Logistics Excellence, Advancement and Performance Shield
- (B) Logistics Evaluation and Achievement Performance System
- (C) Logistics Efficiency, Advancement and Progress Shield
- (D) Logistics Enablement and Performance Standards

Q7.

The LEADS 2025 release is linked to which two national initiatives?

- (A) PM GatiShakti and National Logistics Policy 2022
- (B) Make in India and Digital India
- (C) Digital India and Startup India
- (D) Swachh Bharat and Smart Cities Mission

Pokhran and the 1998 milestones

National Technology Day is observed every year on 11 May. The day commemorates technological achievements reached on 11 May 1998, when several milestones were reached. One of these was a series of nuclear tests conducted at the Pokhran Test Range in Rajasthan. India had earlier carried out a nuclear test at the same range, and the 1998 tests marked a major step in the country's scientific history. Students preparing for current affairs should be clear about the sequence of these events, the people who led them, and the names given to the operations. The 1998 tests were not the only technological milestones of that day. Another was the first successful test flight of the Hansa-3 aircraft, which marked progress in indigenous aviation. The Defence Research and Development Organisation also carried out a test of the Trishul missile, a short-range surface-to-air weapon. Together these events show why the day is linked with self-reliance in technology. The day has been observed every year since the government began marking it in 1999. Preparation tip: when reading about nuclear and technology milestones, note the day, the number of tests in each series, and the codename used for each operation. Such details are easy to confuse, and they are often asked directly. Keeping a short table of dates and events makes revision faster.

Q1.

What was the codename of India's first nuclear test, conducted at Pokhran on 18 May 1974?

- (A) Operation Shakti
- (B) Smiling Buddha
- (C) Operation Trident
- (D) Operation Blue Star

Q2.

How many nuclear tests did India conduct on 11 May 1998 during Pokhran-II?

- (A) One
- (B) Two
- (C) Three
- (D) Five

Q3.

Assertion (A): India is recognised as a nuclear weapons state.

Reason (R): Pokhran-II nuclear tests were conducted in May 1998 under Operation Shakti.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q4.

Consider the following statements about India's nuclear tests:

- I. Pokhran-I was India's first nuclear test and was conducted on 18 May 1974.
- II. The 11 May 1998 series of tests was conducted under the codename Operation Shakti.
- III. Pokhran-I was conducted on 11 May 1974 as part of the Operation Shakti series.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

Consider the following statements about the Pokhran-II tests of May 1998:

- I. Three nuclear tests were conducted on 11 May 1998.
- II. Three nuclear tests were conducted on 13 May 1998.
- III. The tests were India's first confirmed nuclear detonations after 1974.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q6.

Who were the chief coordinators of the Pokhran-II tests?

- (A) Atal Bihari Vajpayee alone
- (B) Abdul Kalam and R. Chidambaram
- (C) Atal Bihari Vajpayee and R. Chidambaram
- (D) Abdul Kalam and Atal Bihari Vajpayee

Q7.

In the order of nations that joined the nuclear club, which position did India reach through the Pokhran-II tests?

- (A) 4th
- (B) 5th
- (C) 6th
- (D) 7th

Constitution and labour laws: practice set

Labour welfare in India is shaped by two sources of authority: the Constitution and a body of ordinary statutes. The Constitution does not only grant rights to individuals; it also sets out aims that the State is expected to pursue. Some provisions protect workers from being made to work against their will, while others shield young people from early employment. Other provisions describe the kind of economic life the State should aim for, including a means of livelihood, employment within economic capacity, fair pay and a voice for workers in the industries where they work. Statutes have translated many of these aims into laws covering factories, wages, provident funds, compensation and disputes between employers and employees. Several of these statutes have since been grouped into a smaller number of broad codes. The codes group rules on wages, industrial relations, social security and occupational safety and health. Each statute addresses a specific aspect of work, such as the payment of wages, the settlement of disputes or compensation to workers. Labour matters also have an international dimension, since a United Nations agency works to improve labour conditions and living standards across the world. Together, these provisions and laws show that labour protection in India has both a constitutional foundation and a statutory one.

Q1.

Which Article of the Indian Constitution prohibits employment of children below the age of 14 years?

- (A) Article 24
- (B) Article 23
- (C) Article 39(a)
- (D) Article 43

Q2.

Which Article of the Indian Constitution orders the State to secure a living wage, decent conditions of work and social and cultural opportunities to all workers?

- (A) Article 39(a)
- (B) Article 41
- (C) Article 43A
- (D) Article 43

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Article 19(1)(c)	A. Equal right to an adequate means of livelihood
II. Article 39(a)	B. Right to work and education within economic capacity
III. Article 43A	C. Right to form associations or unions
IV. Article 41	D. Participation of workers in management of industries

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-C, IV-D
- (D) I-A, II-B, III-C, IV-D

Q4.

Consider the following statements about labour provisions in the Indian Constitution:

- I. Article 23 prohibits forced labour.
- II. Article 19(1)(c) prohibits employment of children below 14 years.
- III. Article 43A provides for participation of workers in management of industries through legislation.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

Consider the following statements about labour laws in India:

- I. The Workmen's Compensation Act was enacted in 1923.
- II. The Payment of Wages Act was enacted in 1948.
- III. The Employees' Provident Fund Act was enacted in 1952.
- IV. The Industrial Disputes Act was enacted in 1947.

How many of the above statements are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All four

Q6.

According to the chart, which labour code amalgamates the largest number of laws?

- (A) Wage Code
- (B) Occupational Safety, Health and Working Conditions Code
- (C) Industrial Relations Code
- (D) Social Security Code

Q7.

In which year was the Contract Labour Act enacted?

- (A) 1923
- (B) 1936
- (C) 1952
- (D) 1970

ASEAN Basics and Forums

Southeast Asia is home to a regional grouping that has become central to how countries in the region manage their relations with one another and with major outside powers. Its members have long preferred a cautious style of diplomacy, in which governments avoid commenting on or interfering in each other's domestic affairs. Leaders and ministers meet through a network of regional forums that cover trade, politics and security, and several of these meetings now include partners from outside the region. The group has also tried to deepen economic ties, aiming to make trade, investment and the movement of people easier across national borders. Its record is not without difficulty. A dispute over a busy sea route has remained unresolved for years, and the group has been criticised for its limited response to a political crisis inside one of its member states. For India, the region has a special importance. New Delhi has built deep political, economic and security ties with the grouping over many years, and its own regional outreach policy places the grouping at the heart of its approach to the wider Indo-Pacific. The group's ability to act together will shape how much influence it can exercise in the years ahead.

Q1.

The ASEAN Regional Forum (ARF) was established in which year?

- (A) 1992
- (B) 1994
- (C) 2005
- (D) 2015

Q2.

Where is the headquarters of ASEAN located?

- (A) Bangkok, Thailand
- (B) Singapore
- (C) Jakarta, Indonesia
- (D) Manila, Philippines

Q3.

In which year was the East Asia Summit (EAS) created?

- (A) 2005
- (B) 2002
- (C) 2015
- (D) 1967

Q4.

On which date did the ASEAN Charter take effect?

- (A) 8 August 1967
- (B) 15 August 1997
- (C) 1 January 2015
- (D) 15 December 2008

Q5.

Assertion (A): Decision-making in ASEAN is done through consultation and consensus.

Reason (R): The ASEAN Charter is legally binding and registered with the UN Secretariat.

Which one of the following is correct?

- (A) Both A and R are true and R explains A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R does not explain A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q6.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. ASEAN Regional Forum	A. Oversees implementation of ASEAN agreements and decisions
II. ASEAN Secretariat	B. Platform for dialogue on political and security issues
III. ASEAN Coordinating Council	C. Leaders-level forum with a varied agenda
IV. East Asia Summit	D. Supports and facilitates ASEAN's activities and initiatives

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (B) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (C) I-A, II-D, III-C, IV-B
- (D) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

I. The ASEAN Charter took effect in 2008 and is legally binding.

II. The RCEP was concluded in 2019 and covers about 30 per cent of the world's population.

III. The ASEAN Free Trade Area was established in 1967.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and II only
- (B) II and III only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q8.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The ASEAN Economic Community was formed in 2015 to facilitate the free flow of goods, services, investments, capital and labour.
- II. The East Asia Summit was created in 2002 as a leaders-level forum.
- III. The East Asia Summit is a leaders-level forum with a varied agenda.
- IV. The ASEAN Regional Forum was established in 1992.

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) None of the above

Governance and Parliamentary Oversight

Governance in India is judged at several levels, and each level has tools to measure performance. At the village level, a national framework assesses how well local bodies deliver rural services. Rather than offering a simple ranking, it places each body into a category based on a composite score, so officials can see where improvement is needed. The framework is also linked to global development goals, which connects local priorities to wider targets for sustainable growth. Accurate measurement depends on good data. Government statistics agencies run regular surveys of economic activity, including enterprises that are not registered as companies. Such data is useful for planning because it captures sectors that formal records often miss. Finally, oversight of public money rests with Parliament. A committee drawn from both Houses examines how the government spends money and studies reports prepared by the country's audit institution. Its members are chosen in a way that reflects the balance of political parties, which gives the committee its credibility. This oversight protects financial discipline in public spending. Together, these mechanisms show how measurement, statistics and legislative scrutiny support accountability in public administration.

Q1.

A Gram Panchayat secures a composite score of 80 under the PAI 2.0 framework. Which grade does it receive?

- (A) Achiever (A+)
- (B) Front Runner (A)
- (C) Performer (B)
- (D) Aspirant (C)

Q2.

Which state had the highest share of Front Runners among the top performers in PAI 2.0?

- (A) Kerala
- (B) Odisha
- (C) Karnataka
- (D) Tripura

Q3.

How many members does the Public Accounts Committee have in total?

- (A) 22
- (B) 15
- (C) 7
- (D) 30

Q4.

Assertion (A): The Public Accounts Committee can examine government expenditure only after it has been incurred.

Reason (R): The recommendations of the Public Accounts Committee are binding on the government.

- (A) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
- (B) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
- (C) A is true but R is false
- (D) A is false but R is true

Q5.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. ASUSE 2025	A. Released by the Ministry of Panchayati Raj
II. Public Accounts Committee	B. Karnataka won the highest number of awards
III. Panchayat Advancement Index 2.0	C. Constituted in 1921 after the Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms
IV. National Panchayat Awards 2025	D. Conducted by the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B
- (B) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A
- (C) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C
- (D) I-B, II-D, III-C, IV-A

Q6.

Consider the following statements:

- I. PAI 2.0 grades Gram Panchayats on a composite score out of 100.
- II. The Front Runner (A) grade covers scores between 60 and 74.
- III. The ASUSE covers both rural and urban India.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) I and III only
- (D) II and III only

Q7.

Consider the following statements:

- I. PAI 2.0 translates 17 SDGs into 9 Localised SDGs.
- II. The National Panchayat Awards were launched in 2011.
- III. ASUSE moved from a calendar-year cycle to an October-September cycle in 2025.
- IV. The Public Accounts Committee was first constituted in 1947, after Independence.

How many of the statements above are correct?

- (A) Only one
- (B) Only two
- (C) Only three
- (D) All of the above

Q8.

By convention, from which group is the Chairperson of the Public Accounts Committee chosen?

- (A) Treasury benches of the ruling party
- (B) Rajya Sabha members only
- (C) Ministry of Finance nominees
- (D) Opposition party

Global Cooperation Check

India's external engagement now reaches small businesses abroad, labour rights at home and the working of central banks. Subrahmanyam Jaishankar inaugurated India-supported projects in Trinidad and Tobago under an initiative that supplies equipment to small and medium enterprises in countries of the Global South. The programme is an Indian developmental cooperation initiative, so its benefits flow to partner countries.

Labour standards also came into focus when tea plantation workers in West Bengal raised allegations of violations in tea estates. The allegations concern conditions inside the tea estates themselves. Their complaint was taken to an international body that holds member countries accountable for implementing ratified conventions. Tea itself is governed by a national board that regulates cultivation, production, sale and export.

On the financial side, the Reserve Bank of India and the European Central Bank have revised a memorandum of understanding, which means an earlier arrangement between them has now been updated. The aim is to enhance cooperation in banking supervision and financial regulation. The euro area is a group of European Union countries that use the euro as their official currency, and its central bank sits at the centre of this cooperation. Over the years, the euro area has expanded as more countries adopted the currency, and additions have come in different years.

Q1.

Which ministry implements the SEEDS initiative?

- (A) Ministry of Information and Broadcasting
- (B) Ministry of Earth Sciences
- (C) Ministry of External Affairs
- (D) Ministry of Defence

Q2.

In which year did Bulgaria join the Eurozone as a recent addition?

- (A) 2026
- (B) 1998
- (C) 2023
- (D) 1960

Q3.

Match List I with List II:

List I	List II
I. Tea Board	A. Implemented by the Ministry of External Affairs
II. European Central Bank	B. Created under the Tea Act 1953
III. Eurozone	C. Headquartered in Frankfurt
IV. SEEDS	D. 21 member countries

Rows are two lists side by side, not matched pairs; work out the correct pairing.

- (A) I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C
- (B) I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A
- (C) I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A
- (D) I-B, II-C, III-A, IV-D

Q4.

Consider the following statements:

- I. Industrial associations of workers or employers' organisations can file a complaint against a member country under Article 24.
- II. Croatia and Bulgaria joined the Eurozone in the same year.
- III. The Eurozone was established under the Maastricht Treaty.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (A) I and III only
- (B) I and II only
- (C) II and III only
- (D) I, II and III

Q5.

How many of the following statements are correct?

- I. The SEEDS initiative supports small and medium enterprises in Global South countries.
- II. The RBI and the ECB have signed a revised MoU on banking supervision.
- III. The Tea Board was established by a 1960 Act.
- IV. The Eurozone has 27 member countries.

- (A) Only three
- (B) None
- (C) Only one
- (D) Only two

Q6.

Tea plantation workers in West Bengal invoked Article 24 of the constitution of which international body?

- (A) European Central Bank
- (B) Reserve Bank of India
- (C) Tea Board
- (D) International Labour Organization

Q7.

In which year was the Eurozone established under the Maastricht Treaty?

- (A) 1960
- (B) 1992
- (C) 1998
- (D) 2023

Type-in-the-answer passages

Nordic and Sweden Ties

Prime Minister Narendra Modi's engagements in the Nordic region combined a visit to Norway with participation in a regional summit series. The Nordic countries form a group in Northern Europe, and India has held a series of summits with them. Relations with Norway moved to a higher level, with a focus on clean energy, climate resilience, the blue economy and green shipping. Norway also joined an Indo-Pacific initiative led by India.

Sweden was the other key partner in this round. The two countries moved their ties to a strategic partnership and adopted a joint action plan that covers the years ahead. They endorsed joint development of a technology and artificial intelligence corridor, and agreed to set up a platform for small enterprises and start-ups. Modi also received a Swedish order that is among the highest honours a head of government can receive.

Economic links also matter. Norway's sovereign wealth fund has invested in India, and a trade agreement between India and the European Free Trade Association has been signed. Together, these steps show how the Nordic engagement joins climate, technology, trade and diplomacy in one strategy. The agreements cover both existing commitments and plans for future cooperation, so the outcomes are best read as a set of linked steps rather than isolated events.

Q1.

In how many years was PM Modi's visit to Norway the first bilateral visit by an Indian PM? (answer in years)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which city was the 3rd India-Nordic Summit held?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which partnership did India and Norway upgrade their ties to? (name the partnership)

Answer: _____

Q4.

About how much has the Norwegian Sovereign Wealth Fund (GPF) invested in India? (in USD billion)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year did India and Sweden launch LeadIT at the UN Climate Action Summit?

Answer: _____

Q6.

For which period is the India-Sweden Joint Action Plan designed? (give the years)

Answer: _____

Q7.

How many countries form the core Nordic group, as listed in the booklet?

Answer: _____

Reasons and Impact: Short Answer Set

One reason given for the UAE's exit is that output limits set through the producer group kept it from using its growing production capacity in full. The country's outlook looks ahead to a time when global oil demand may peak and then decline gradually. Its present approach is to earn strong oil revenues in the near term while preparing for a longer-term shift to renewable energy.

Those revenues are intended to help fund growth in artificial intelligence and data centres, supporting a more diversified economy. Friction within the producer group over production policy has been long-standing, and rivalry between the UAE and a regional neighbour over economic and political influence has intensified. Infrastructure also adds flexibility: an inland pipeline in the UAE carries crude from oil fields to a coastal terminal on the Gulf of Oman, which helps exporters when shipping routes face disruption risks. For India, which imports a large share of its crude, lower oil prices would reduce import costs and ease inflation pressure, while a move away from group restrictions could allow direct bilateral deals. The booklet also notes that rising volatility could complicate long-term energy budgeting. Taken together, these developments show how energy, security and economic strategy are tied together in the Gulf.

Q1.

By 2027, what daily production level (in million barrels per day) does the UAE aim to reach?

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which port does the Habshan-Fujairah Pipeline connect the inland oil fields to?

Answer: _____

Q3.

With which regional oil producer does the UAE have long-standing tensions over OPEC production policy?

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which currency would the UAE's exit encourage energy settlements for India, supporting its de-dollarisation strategy?

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year was the OPEC+ alliance formed?

Answer: _____

Q6.

Roughly what percentage of the world's crude oil does OPEC+ pump (in per cent)?

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which former OPEC member was suspended from the group in 1992?

Answer: _____

Public Examination Act check

The Public Examination (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act 2024 was framed to curb paper leaks, organised cheating and manipulation in recruitment and entrance examinations. It covers a broad range of unfair means. Leaking question papers or answer keys, impersonating a candidate, and giving unauthorised assistance during an examination are all covered. So are tampering with computer systems or networks, conducting fake examinations, and manipulating merit lists or official documents.

Punishments depend on the offence and on the person responsible. Individuals who are found guilty can face imprisonment as well as monetary penalties, and organised malpractice carries monetary penalties as well. Service providers who run examinations can be fined and barred from conducting examinations for a fixed period. Organised crimes are punished separately under the Act.

Offences under the Act are serious. Investigations are carried out by senior police officers, and the Central Government has the power to shift an investigation to a central agency where needed. Together, these provisions treat examination fraud as a serious crime rather than a minor lapse.

Q1.

What is the minimum imprisonment (in years) for an individual found guilty under the Act?

Answer: _____

Q2.

For how many years can a service provider be debarred from conducting examinations (in years)?

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the maximum monetary penalty (in crore rupees) for an individual in a case involving organised malpractice?

Answer: _____

Q4.

What is the minimum imprisonment (in years) for organised crimes under the Act?

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which two property-related measures can be applied to organised crimes under the Act (give both terms)?

Answer: _____

Q6.

What is the maximum imprisonment (in years) for an individual found guilty under the Act?

Answer: _____

Q7.

What is the maximum fine (in crore rupees) for a service provider under the Act?

Answer: _____

Places of Worship Act: key details

The Places of Worship Act, 1991 was passed by a Congress government to protect the religious identity of places of worship. Its central aim is to keep the religious character of each place as it stood on Independence Day. The Act prohibits converting a place of worship from one religious denomination to another, whether between or within denominations. It terminates pending legal proceedings about religious character conversions that took place before the cut-off, while allowing new cases about changes made after it. Violating the Act attracts imprisonment and fines. The Act exempts ancient monuments protected under the Ancient Monuments and Archaeological Sites and Remains Act, and it does not cover the Ayodhya dispute and related legal proceedings. Critics argue that the Act limits judicial review, weakening constitutional checks and balances. Others say that it violates the right to freedom of religion and treats communities differently, undermining equality. Critics also argue that the Independence Day cut-off ignores historical injustices and earlier encroachments. The Supreme Court, in its verdict on the Ayodhya dispute, said that the Act upholds secular values and prohibits retrogression. Its supporters say the Act ensures the preservation of religious sites and their character, instilling confidence in all communities. Together, these points explain why the Act remains a contested law.

Q1.

In which year is the religious character of places of worship frozen to its Independence Day status? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the Ancient Monuments and Archaeological Sites and Remains Act enacted? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Under which section of the Places of Worship Act are penalties provided? (section number)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Under which section are legal proceedings on pre-1947 religious character conversions terminated? (section number)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which Prime Minister led the Congress government that passed the Places of Worship Act? (name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Under which section of the Places of Worship Act is conversion of a place of worship prohibited? (section number)

Answer: _____

Appointment, Tenure and Removal Facts

Judges of the Supreme Court are appointed by the President, and the Constitution lays down the qualifications a person must have before appointment. A candidate must be a citizen of India and must meet one of several experience-based or distinguished-jurist criteria. Once in office, a judge does not serve a fixed term. Instead, the judge continues until reaching a set retirement age, and may also choose to leave earlier by writing to the President. The Constitution provides a formal route for removal, which is demanding. Removal is permitted only on the grounds of proven misbehaviour or incapacity. A special law governs the procedure, and the same process applies to judges of the Supreme Court and of the High Courts. Several judges have faced removal motions in Parliament, and in some cases the motion failed or the judge resigned before the process was complete. The question of who should decide appointments has been debated for decades, and Court rulings have repeatedly reshaped the process. Consultation between the Chief Justice and other senior judges sits at the heart of that debate. These disputes show how closely appointments and removals are linked to judicial independence.

Q1.

Until what age (in years) does a Supreme Court judge hold office?

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was the Act that governs the removal procedure for Supreme Court and High Court judges enacted?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which judge was impeached in Rajya Sabha in 2011 but resigned before the Lok Sabha discussion? (full name)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year did the Supreme Court, in the Second Judges Case, hold that consultation means concurrence?

Answer: _____

Q5.

According to the Third Judges Case, how many seniormost judges make up the collegium that the CJI must consult? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q6.

How many eminent persons from civil society are to be nominated to the NJAC? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Who was appointed Chief Justice of India in 1977 by superseding HR Khanna? (name as in text)

Answer: _____

Deciding Authority and Review

Once a disqualification petition is filed against a legislator, the central question becomes who decides it. The Constitution gives this power to the presiding officer of the house to which the member belongs, rather than to a court or to the executive. Critics argue that this arrangement places a significant power in the hands of someone who is often a member of the ruling party, which raises concerns about partisanship. Courts can step in, but generally only after the presiding officer has issued a decision, so the timing of judicial intervention is a recurring concern. Petitions can remain pending for long periods, and that delay can shape the stability of a government long before a final verdict is reached. Judges have said such decisions should be taken within a reasonable timeframe, although deadlines are not always met in practice. A decision may be reviewed by a court on specific grounds, such as when it violates a constitutional requirement, reflects bad faith, or is so unreasonable that no proper authority could have reached it. The procedure also has to respect basic fairness, which means the affected member must be heard. Such review is an important safeguard, yet it does not replace the initial role of the presiding officer in the process.

Q1.

Who decides disqualification petitions for members of the Lok Sabha? (designation)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Who decides disqualification petitions for members of the Rajya Sabha? (designation)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What fraction of the members of a legislature party must agree for a merger to avoid disqualification? (in words)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Within how many months should decisions on disqualification ideally be made, as per *Keisham Meghachandra Singh vs Speaker Manipur (2020)*? (in months)

Answer: _____

Q5.

After how many months of nomination does a nominated member become liable to disqualification for joining a party? (in months)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which 2019 case involving the Karnataka Speaker lists the grounds for reviewing a Speaker's decision? (first-named party's name)

Answer: _____

Q7.

What is the first-named party in the 1992 judgment on Speaker's decisions under the Tenth Schedule? (name)

Answer: _____

Import Pressure Check

India's external payments depend heavily on what the country imports. Energy is among the largest of these imports, and India relies on foreign suppliers for most of its crude oil. When oil prices move sharply, the import bill changes with them, which affects the trade balance and the demand for dollars. Gold is another major import. Household purchases of gold do not create productive assets in the way that official reserves do, so heavy gold buying adds to the strain on the current account. Fertiliser is a third pressure point. Imported inputs such as urea and ammonia have risen sharply in price, and the government must decide how to respond. It can pass the higher costs on to consumers, which carries a risk of inflation, or it can absorb the costs itself. A weaker rupee adds to the problem, because it makes every imported good more expensive in rupee terms. Outflows also arise from personal spending abroad, such as foreign travel and overseas weddings. Each of these pressures feeds the others, and the economy has to weigh short-term relief against long-term health. Understanding which imports drive the outflow of foreign exchange is the first step in judging how much pressure the economy faces. Policy choices in this area therefore matter a great deal for households and businesses.

Q1.

What share of its crude oil requirement does India import, according to the booklet? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which country is the largest gold consumer globally, per the booklet? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What share of India's total imports does gold account for? (in per cent)

Answer: _____

Q4.

How did imported urea and ammonia prices change, according to the booklet? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which security does the government prioritise over discretionary fuel consumption when fertiliser prices surge? (two words)

Answer: _____

Q6.

If the government absorbs cost increases instead of passing them on, which risk arises? (name the risk)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Under which scheme does the booklet record significant foreign exchange outflows? (name in full)

Answer: _____

History of the Indian Press

Printing reached India through European trading companies, and for a long time newspapers were produced by colonial interests and Indian reformers alike. Colonial governments were uneasy about printed criticism. At different times they introduced rules to control what could be published, and some of these rules fell hardest on publications written in Indian languages. Even so, Indian editors kept bringing out weeklies that promoted social reform and nationalist ideas. Reformers used the press to challenge customs and argue for change in society. Over time, the limits on the press became a question for the courts and the constitution. Debates about press freedom focused on how expression could be balanced with public order and the rights of others. Later, statutory and non-statutory bodies were set up to watch over journalism and protect editorial standards, while professional associations of editors took up the defence of journalists' rights. Studying this history explains why modern India treats press freedom as important yet not absolute, and why the state and the press continue to debate where the limits should lie. The sequence of laws and institutions shows a long pattern in which governments tried to restrict the press while journalists sought wider freedom.

Q1.

In which year was India's first newspaper, the Bengal Gazette, published? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

Who published the Bengal Gazette? (full name)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which Act issued by Lord Wellesley in 1799 curbed the press? (name of Act)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which 1835 Act is described as the liberator of the Indian press? (name of Act)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year was the Vernacular Press Act enacted to suppress Indian press freedom? (year)

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year was the Press Council of India abolished during the Emergency? (year)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Under which Act was the Press Council of India established as a statutory quasi-judicial body in 1978? (name of Act with year)

Answer: _____

Freight corridor figures

Dedicated Freight Corridors are exclusive tracks built for freight trains, and they support double-stack and heavy-haul trains that offer high capacity and speed. The corridors fall under the Ministry of Railways, and their implementation is handled by a dedicated corporation. A key objective is to reduce logistics costs, in line with the National Logistics Policy. The Western Dedicated Freight Corridor begins at JNPT in Mumbai, and it has improved port access and lowered transit times. Corridors of this kind have also generated jobs and attracted investment, which supports economic growth. Indian Railways' revenue growth is also linked to these corridors over a multi-year period. Construction has not been free of difficulty, because delays in the final section of the Western corridor added to project costs. Within the wider national plan, the corridors are expected to raise the share of rail in freight movement. The corridors are part of a larger network that is being built across several regions of the country.

Q1.

Which organisation is the implementing agency for the Dedicated Freight Corridors? (give the abbreviation)

Answer: _____

Q2.

By which year do the Dedicated Freight Corridors aim to raise rail's share of freight to 45% under the National Rail Plan? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Under the National Logistics Policy, logistics costs are to be brought below what percentage? (in per cent, number only)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Up to which financial year is the period cited for DFCs' contribution to Indian Railways' revenue growth? (format: 2022-23)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which place is at the other end of the North-South DFC from Vijayawada? (one word)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What is the length of the North-South DFC? (in km)

Answer: _____

Q7.

What is the length of the East Coast DFC between Kharagpur and Vijayawada? (in km)

Answer: _____

Space and defence firsts

India's space programme has grown steadily over the years and now covers lunar, Martian and solar missions, along with satellites and launch services. Each mission was designed to answer a scientific question or to prove a new capability. Some missions were firsts for the country, while a

few were firsts for the world. The programme is also opening up to private participation through bodies created for that purpose, which marks a change in how space work is organised. Upcoming missions are planned for later years and will extend the country's reach further. Defence technology has developed on a parallel track. Warships, submarines and combat aircraft built in India show how indigenous design has been applied to strategic needs. Examinations often test these achievements through a single detail, such as a mission name, a ship's name or a year. A simple timeline that places each mission and each vessel in order makes these details easier to recall. Revision should focus on what each achievement was, who achieved it first, and when it happened. Learning each mission together with its first is a practical method for exam preparation. Students who connect each achievement with its date and its institution find recall far easier than those who memorise isolated lists.

Q1.

Which Indian mission, India's first lunar mission, discovered water on the Moon? (give the mission name)

Answer: _____

Q2.

How many satellites were launched in one launch in 2017, a world record? (in number)

Answer: _____

Q3.

What is the name of India's first indigenous aircraft carrier? (name of the ship)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which submarine, dated 1967, was India's first indigenous submarine? (name of the submarine)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which crewed spaceflight, planned for 2027, will be India's first? (name of the mission)

Answer: _____

Q6.

What is the name of India's first solar mission? (name of the mission)

Answer: _____

ILO: short answer set

Some international bodies are created to set common standards rather than to govern countries directly. The body discussed here is one of them, and its concern is the working life of people across the world. It was set up under the Treaty of Versailles and was later linked with the United Nations. Its central aim is to improve labour conditions and living standards throughout the world. Its structure gives an equal voice to three groups: governments, employers and workers. The organisation has four stated objectives. It seeks to promote fundamental labour rights, create greater opportunities for women and men, enhance social protection and strengthen social dialogue. Its legal instruments take two forms. Conventions and Protocols are legally binding treaties, while Recommendations are non-binding guidelines. Some of its standards form part of the wider United Nations human rights framework. The organisation also publishes reports on employment, wages, social protection and youth. Its Director General leads the organisation's work. The work covers workers in many countries, including India, which is one of its founding members. Taken together, these standards and reports show how an international body can influence labour conditions.

Q1.

In which year did the ILO become the first specialised agency associated with the United Nations? (year)

Answer: _____

Q2.

According to the booklet, who is the Director General of the ILO? (name)

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which city is the headquarters of the ILO located? (city)

Answer: _____

Q4.

In which year was the ILO awarded the Nobel Prize for Peace? (year)

Answer: _____

Q5.

In which year was the ILO Declaration on Fundamental Principles and Rights at Work adopted? (year)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which ILO Convention number deals with Minimum Age? (number)

Answer: _____

Q7.

Which ILO Convention number deals with Freedom of Association? (number)

Answer: _____

RBI Surplus and Capital Framework

The Reserve Bank of India earns income from its operations, and every year it decides how much of that income to keep and how much to pass on to the central government. The rules for these decisions are set out in a framework known as the Economic Capital Framework, which tells the bank how to provide for financial risks and how to transfer its surplus. A surplus is the net income left after total expenditure is deducted from total income. The bank earns this income from buying and selling bonds in the market, from the interest it receives on bonds it holds, and from returns on its foreign currency assets. To guard against unexpected losses, such as falls in the value of securities or the effects of changes in interest rates, the bank maintains a contingency buffer. The surplus is handed over to the government only after this buffer has reached its target level. The bank's board has recently approved a record transfer to the government, and the framework itself has been reviewed by expert committees over time. Analysts see these transfers as helping the government with its finances, reducing its borrowing needs and supporting its spending on infrastructure.

Q1.

In which year was the RBI's Economic Capital Framework introduced?

Answer: _____

Q2.

Which person headed the committee that reviewed the 2015-16 Economic Capital Framework?

Answer: _____

Q3.

In which year did the RBI Board's Technical Committee, led by YH Malegam, make its recommendation on surplus transfers?

Answer: _____

Q4.

Under which section of the RBI Act, 1934 must the RBI's profits be sent to the Centre?

Answer: _____

Q5.

How often must the Economic Capital Framework be reviewed, in years?

Answer: _____

Q6.

In which year was the Enterprise-Wide Risk Management Framework, of which the Contingency Risk Buffer forms the core, introduced?

Answer: _____

Q7.

The RBI's surplus transfer to the government typically averages around what percentage of GDP (in per cent)?

Answer: _____

Methane, Solar Wind and Space Missions

Monitoring the atmosphere and the space around Earth has become a major scientific priority. Methane is a gas that traps heat far more strongly than carbon dioxide over short periods, so detecting its leaks quickly matters for climate action. A satellite-based system has been designed to spot large leaks, the kind that release huge amounts of gas in a short time, and to help operators reduce them. The system was unveiled at a major international climate conference and has since been widened to cover new sources of emissions. Countries have also agreed on global targets for cutting methane, with a deadline later in the decade measured against an earlier baseline year. Turning from the air to the space around Earth, the Sun constantly releases a stream of charged particles that flows past our planet. Earth's magnetic field deflects much of this flow, and the region where the two interact shapes how well the planet is shielded from harmful radiation. A new mission from a European space agency and a partner from East Asia studies this interaction. It captures images in two kinds of light at the same time and tracks how the solar flow meets the magnetic shield in near real time. Scientists hope these observations will show how the upper atmosphere responds when the Sun is active, and how the magnetic shield changes under pressure from the solar wind.

Q1.

Which satellite-based system, launched in 2022, detects major methane leaks? Give its acronym.

Answer: _____

Q2.

By how much, in per cent, does the Global Methane Pledge aim to cut global methane emissions by 2030 compared with 2020 levels?

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which Chinese institution co-launched the SMILE mission with the European Space Agency?

Answer: _____

Q4.

From which French overseas territory was the SMILE spacecraft launched?

Answer: _____

Q5.

SMILE stands for Solar Wind Magnetosphere Ionosphere ____ Explorer. Fill in the blank.

Answer: _____

Q6.

Along with China and India, which country is named among the world's largest methane emitters?

Answer: _____

Environment and Weather Check

Human-elephant conflict is a serious concern for communities living near elephant habitats, and it affects both people and the animals. The central government runs a national programme that protects elephants, conserves their habitats and maintains the corridors they use to move. A state has now decided to create a dedicated research centre on this conflict. Other measures focus on people and their livelihoods. Public awareness drives, community sensitisation and conservation education are meant to reduce retaliatory violence. One method uses bees to reduce elephant-human attacks, and it is run by a national body that supports village industries. A separate public campaign encourages coexistence between humans and elephants. Weather and air also need careful observation in cities. Under Mission Mausam, an urban testbed and aerosol observatory has been inaugurated in a city. Its work is linked with a Chennai-based research institute. The facility observes urban weather in real time, tracks air quality and aerosols, and supports climate-related research. The facility works in an urban setting, where weather and air observation are tracked in one system.

Q1.

Which tiger reserve will host India's dedicated Human-Elephant Conflict Research Centre? (name of reserve)

Answer: _____

Q2.

In which year was Project Elephant launched by the Government of India? (year)

Answer: _____

Q3.

Which campaign promotes coexistence between humans and elephants? (name of campaign)

Answer: _____

Q4.

Which institute in Chennai is associated with India's Urban Testbed and Aerosol Observatory? (full name)

Answer: _____

Q5.

Which ministry inaugurated India's Urban Testbed and Aerosol Observatory under Mission Mausam? (ministry name)

Answer: _____

Q6.

Which state is set to establish India's dedicated Human-Elephant Conflict Research Centre? (name of state)

Answer: _____